SERVICENOW | IMPORT SETS

Import Data using Transform Maps

Customer Journey Map: Spreadsheet to employee-linked, secured records

Persona: ServiceNow Administrator / HR data owner
Team ID: _____ Date: 03 October 2026
Project: Employee Data Import using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

SCENARIO

Importing employee data from a spreadsheet, linking each record to an employee, and securing it with ACLs

	1 Entice	2 Enter	3 Engage	4 Exit	5 Extend
	How does someone initially become aware of this process?	What does the admin experience as they begin the process?	In the core moments of the process, what happens?	What does the admin experience as the process finishes?	What happens after the import is done?
Steps What does the admin typically experience?	Receives employee spreadsheet from HR	Notices records need employee and department details	Decides to use Import Set and Transform Map	Cleans headers, blank rows and columns	Creates Data Source and attaches the file	Clicks Load All Records	Creates Transform Map (staging to target table)	Maps fields; Employee ID to reference field; sets Coalesce	Runs the Transform on the Import Set	Reviews Transform History counts	Verifies records in target table	Creates ACLs and tests with Impersonate User	Uses employee-linked records in reports	Schedules imports for updates	Reuses the Transform Map for new files
Interactions What interactions do they have at each step? People: HR, managers Places: ServiceNow modules Things: files, tables, maps	Email or shared drive (Excel / CSV)	Target table list view	Team chat with HR	Excel or CSV file	System Import Sets > Data Sources	Import Set staging table (u_)	System Import Sets > Transform Maps	Field Maps list and Mapping Assist	Transform button on the Import Set	Transform History and Import Log	Target table list view (Users / custom)	Impersonate User menu and Access Control (ACL) records	Reports and dashboards	Scheduled Imports module	Transform Map record
Goals & motivations At each step, what is the admin's primary goal? ("Help me..." or "Help me avoid...")	Help me bring all employee data in quickly	Help me link every record to an employee	Help me avoid typing hundreds of rows	Help me avoid file format errors	Help me load data without duplicates	Help me see the raw rows safely first	Help me map each column correctly	Help me avoid duplicates (Coalesce)	Help me pull in department automatically	Help me confirm every row imported	Help me restrict who sees sensitive fields	Help me prove the ACLs work	Help me report by department easily	Help me keep data up to date	Help me reuse my setup next time
Positive moments What steps does the admin find enjoyable, productive, motivating or exciting?		Bulk import saves hours of manual entry		Loaded rows appear instantly in the staging table		Staging table keeps raw data safe	Auto Map Matching Fields saves time	Coalesce prevents duplicates		Transform History shows inserted and updated counts		Impersonate User gives instant ACL feedback	Department-wise reports become easy		Scheduled imports save effort
Negative moments What steps does the admin find frustrating, confusing, costly or time-consuming?	Spreadsheets arrive in different formats		Unsure how to link data to employees		Wrong sheet or header setting loads no rows	Merged cells and blank rows cause errors	Reference field not matching leaves values empty	Date format mismatch		Ignored or skipped rows are hard to trace		Wrong ACL blocks valid users		Changed data needs repeated imports	Mapping breaks if columns change
Areas of opportunity How might we make each step better? What ideas do we have?	How might we standardise the spreadsheet template?				How might we validate files before loading?		How might we auto-fill department with a script?		How might we use a unique Employee ID as Coalesce?	How might we alert on failed rows?		How might we test ACLs with several roles?	How might we build department dashboards?	How might we schedule imports automatically?	